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Inventor(s)	Byrne; Robert Dennis

Blank and paperboard envelope formed therefrom

Abstract

A blank including a single rectangular sheet of paperboard having opposed top and bottom edges and opposed left and right edges. The sheet has a midline spaced equally from the left and right edges, with a cut that extends from the top edge to a point spaced from the top edge, and a fold line that extends from the point to the bottom edge. The sheet also has a first zone that extends from midline to right edge along the bottom edge, a second zone that extends from bottom edge to a line spaced from the top edge along the right edge, a third zone that extends from midline to left edge along the bottom edge, and a fourth zone that extends from bottom edge to the line along the left edge. The first and second zones are configured to join the third and fourth zones.

Inventors:	Byrne; Robert Dennis (Cedar Lake, IN)
Applicant:	Calumet Carton Company (South Holland, IL)
Family ID:	78221741
Assignee:	Calumet Carton Company (South Holland, IL)
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Primary Examiner: Pascua; Jes F

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Cook Alex Ltd.

Background/Summary

(1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/241,301, filed Apr. 27, 2021, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent App. No. 63/016,284, filed Apr. 27, 2020, both of which applications are hereby incorporated by reference herein. (2) This patent is directed to a blank for a paperboard envelope and a paperboard envelope formed therefrom.

SUMMARY

(1) According to an aspect, a blank for forming a paperboard envelope is provided, the blank including a single rectangular sheet of paperboard having opposed top and bottom edges and

opposed left and right edges. The sheet has a midline spaced equally from the left and right edges. The midline includes a cut that extends from the top edge to a point spaced from the top edge, and a fold line that extends from the point to the bottom edge. The sheet also has a first zone that extends from the midline to the right edge along the bottom edge, a second zone that extends from the bottom edge to a line spaced from the top edge, the line parallel to the top and bottom edges and disposed through the point, along the right edge, a third zone that extends from the midline to the left edge along the bottom edge, and a fourth zone that extends from the bottom edge to the line along the left edge. The first and second zones are configured to join the third and fourth zones, respectively, with the blank folded about the fold line.

(2) According to a further aspect, a paperboard envelope is formed from a blank including a single rectangular sheet of paperboard having opposed top and bottom edges and opposed left and right edges. The sheet has a midline spaced equally from the left and right edges. The midline includes a cut that extends from the top edge to a point spaced from the top edge, and a fold line that extends from the point to the bottom edge. The sheet also has a first zone that extends from the midline to the right edge along the bottom edge, a second zone that extends from the bottom edge to a line spaced from the top edge, the line parallel to the top and bottom edges and disposed through the point, along the right edge, a third zone that extends from the midline to the left edge along the bottom edge, and a fourth zone that extends from the bottom edge to the line along the left edge. The first and second zones are configured to join the third and fourth zones, respectively, with the blank folded about the fold line.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a plan view of a blank used to form a paperboard envelope;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a front view of the paperboard envelope formed from the blank of FIG. 1; and
- (3) FIG. 3 is a back view of the paperboard envelope formed from the blank of FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF VARIOUS EMBODIMENTS

(4) FIG. 1 illustrates a blank **100** for forming a paperboard envelope according to the disclosed embodiments. The blank **100** can be used to form a paperboard envelope **200**, such as illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3.

(5) The blank **100** includes a single rectangular sheet **102** of paperboard having opposed top and bottom edges **104**, **106** and opposed left and right edges **108**, **110**. The sheet **102** has a midline **112** spaced equally from the left and right edges **108**, **110**, and parallel to the left and right edges **108**, **110**. The midline **112** includes a cut **114** that extends from the top edge **104** to a point **116** spaced from the top edge **104** (e.g., about 1 inch (2.5 cm) from the top edge **104**), and a fold line **118** that extends from the point **116** to the bottom edge **106**.

(6) The sheet **102** also has a first zone **120** that extends from the midline **112** to the right edge **110** along the bottom edge **106**, a second zone **122** that extends from the bottom edge **106** to a line **124** spaced from the top edge **104** along the right edge **110**, a third zone **126** that extends from the midline **112** to the left edge **108** along the bottom edge **106**, and a fourth zone **128** that extends from the bottom edge **106** to the line **124** along the left edge **108**. The line **124** is parallel to the top and bottom edges **104**, **106** and disposed through the point **116**. The first and second zones **120**, **122** are configured to join the third and fourth zones **126**, **128**, respectively, with the blank **100** folded about the fold line **118**.

(7) During assembly, the blank **100** may be folded about the fold line **118**, such that the first zone **120** overlies the third zone **126** and the second zone **122** overlies the fourth zone **128**. The first and third zones **120**, **126** then may be joined together, as may the second and fourth zones **122**, **128**, to form the envelope **200**. With the first and third zones **120**, **126** and second and fourth zones **122**,

128 secured, the regions of between the top edge **104** and the line **124** may be left unsecured to permit an article or articles (e.g., an item of apparel, such as a shirt or sweater) to be introduced into the envelope **200**. A fastener may be associated with these regions to permit the envelope **200** to be closed after the article or articles has/have been disposed within the envelope **200**.

(8) Having thus described the blank **100** and the method of assembling the blank **100** into the envelope **200**, further details are described about the blank **100** and the envelope **200** with reference to FIGS. 1-3.

(9) Referring first to FIG. 1, the blank **100** includes a rectangular sheet **102** of paperboard, as mentioned above. As such, the top edge **104** is parallel to the bottom edge **106**, and the left edge **108** is parallel to the right edge **110**. According to certain embodiments, the distance from the top edge **104** to the bottom edge **106** is 17.5 inches (43.75 cm), and the distance from the left edge **108** to the right edge **110** is 28.5 inches (71.25 cm). According to such embodiments, the sheet of paperboard may be an uncoated, recycled, TBC grade of paperboard, with a thickness of 0.015 inches (0.381 mm). According to other embodiments, the dimensions may differ, and the grade and thickness of paperboard may differ.

(10) The top, bottom, left and right edges **104**, **106**, **108**, **110** are free of tabs or extensions: that is, there are no sections of the rectangular sheet **102** that have been removed to form the blank **100**, such as might have been removed to form trapezoidal or other shaped regions depending from any of the top, bottom, left, and right edges **104**, **106**, **108**, **110**. An advantage of this structure is that there is no material waste in forming the blank, such as might arise from forming the blank with tabs or extensions along one or more of the edges **104**, **106**, **108**, **110**. There is also a savings in processing time and cost related to the elimination of steps to form such tabs or extensions.

(11) As was also mentioned previously, the first and second zones **120**, **122** are configured to be joined to the third and fourth zones **126**, **128**. According to one embodiment, the first and second zones **120**, **122** may be configured to be joined to the third and fourth zones **126**, **128** by disposing an adhesive on the first and second zones **120**, **122**, while the third and fourth zones **126**, **128** are left clear. Alternatively, the first and second zones **120**, **122** may be configured by leaving these zones clear, and disposing the adhesive in the third and fourth zones **126**, **128**. According to other embodiments, adhesive may be disposed in all four zones. The adhesive may be a formulated synthetic resin emulsion adhesive.

(12) It will be recognized that the zones, for example first and third zones **120**, **126** and second and fourth zones **122**, **128**, may be joined and secured to each other in such a fashion that the interface between the zones does not have large gaps. It is preferred that the zones be joined in such a fashion that the interfaces are substantially uniform, such that the first and third zones **120**, **126** and second and fourth zones **122**, **128** are joined and secured completely (i.e., without any gaps) along almost the entire length of their interfaces. For example, the zones may be joined and secured completely along at least 90%, 95% or 100% of their length.

(13) The joined and secured zones **120**, **122**, **126**, **128** and the midline **112** define an interior space of the envelope **200** along three sides of that space. The fourth side is defined by two opposing flaps **130**, **132**. Each flap **130**, **132** is defined between one of the left and right edges **108**, **110** and the midline **112**, and in particular the cut **114**. The flaps **130**, **132** may be joined using a fastener provided for the user to join and secure the flaps **130**, **132** to each other.

(14) For example, a fifth zone **134** may be defined that extends from the midline **112** to the right edge **110** along the top edge **104**. An adhesive may be disposed in the fifth zone **134**, and a release liner **136** may be disposed over the adhesive in the fifth zone **134**. When the liner **136** is removed, the adhesive is exposed and can be used to seal the envelope **200** in a closed state. Such a structure may be referred to conventionally as a peel-and-seal fastener or closure, although other types of self-seal fasteners or closures may be used. The adhesive may be a pressure-sensitive adhesive, such as a pressure sensitive hot-melt adhesive.

(15) In addition, the blank **100** may also include a mechanism for opening the envelope **200** formed

using the blank **100** without resort to scissors or the like. For example, the blank **100** may include a tear strip **138** disposed between the line **124** and the bottom edge **106**, the tear strip **138** having a first end **140** spaced from the midline **112** and a second end **142** spaced from the right edge **110**. The first and second ends **140**, **142** may be cut through or scored into the sheet **102** in such a way that the user may grasp one of the ends **140**, **142** and tear an opening through the sheet **102** to permit articles to be removed from the formed envelope **200**. The tear strip **138** may have a region of reinforcement to guide the tear through the sheet **102**, such as might be provided by a strip of reinforcing material disposed on and joined to (e.g., adhered to) a surface of the sheet **102** between the first and second ends **140**, **142**.

(16) The blank **100** may also have one or more lines spaced inwardly from the left edge **108**, the bottom edge **106**, and the right edge **110**, the lines being scored or grooved. As illustrated, there are lines **150**, **152**, **154**, **156**, **158**, **160** spaced from the bottom, left, and right edges **106**, **108**, **110**, as well as the midline **112**. For example, the lines may be spaced from the edges **106**, **108**, **110** and the midline **112** by 0.75 inches (1.875 cm). The lines **150**, **152**, **154** may be connected, as may the lines **156**, **158**, **160**. According to certain embodiments, these lines may have a mechanical function, but according to other embodiments, the lines are included purely for decoration.

(17) FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate the envelope **200** formed using the blank of FIG. 1. Certain features of the blank **100**, such as the flaps **130**, **132**, the peel-and-seal fastener **134**, **136** and the tear strip **138** are labeled in FIGS. 2 and 3, as are the lines **150**, **152**, **154**, **156**, **158**, **160**.

(18) As illustrated, the envelope **200** has opposing ends **202**, **204** and opposing sides **206**, **208**. The end **202** includes the flaps **130**, **132**, while the opposed end **204** is formed by the joined and secured first and third zones **120**, **126**. The side **206** is formed by the joined and secured second and fourth zones **122**, **128**, while the side **208** is formed at the fold line **118** when the blank **100** is folded about the fold line **118**. The envelope **200** has an interior space that is defined on three sides by the end **204** and the sides **206**, **208** and on a fourth side selectively by the end **202** with flaps **130**, **132**. When formed, before an article or articles are disposed in the envelope **200**, the envelope **200** is empty and flat.

(19) As noted above, the flaps **130**, **132** may be joined and secured using, for example, the peel-and-seal fastener **134**, **136** to prevent an article from being removed from the interior space. On the other hand, the tear strip **138** may be used to form an opening in a wall of the envelope to permit the article to be removed from the interior space. As such, the envelope permits a user to selectively close and open the envelope **200** without other equipment or supplies (e.g., glue, scissors, etc.).

(20) Although the preceding text sets forth a detailed description of different embodiments of the invention, it should be understood that the legal scope of the invention is defined by the words of the claims set forth at the end of this patent. The detailed description is to be construed as exemplary only and does not describe every possible embodiment of the invention since describing every possible embodiment would be impractical, if not impossible. Numerous alternative embodiments could be implemented, using either current technology or technology developed after the filing date of this patent, which would still fall within the scope of the claims defining the invention.

(21) It should also be understood that, unless a term is expressly defined in this patent using the sentence “As used herein, the term ‘_____’ is hereby defined to mean . . .” or a similar sentence, there is no intent to limit the meaning of that term, either expressly or by implication, beyond its plain or ordinary meaning, and such term should not be interpreted to be limited in scope based on any statement made in any section of this patent (other than the language of the claims). To the extent that any term recited in the claims at the end of this patent is referred to in this patent in a manner consistent with a single meaning, that is done for sake of clarity only so as to not confuse the reader, and it is not intended that such claim term be limited, by implication or otherwise, to that single meaning. Finally, unless a claim element is defined by reciting the word “means” and a

function without the recital of any structure, it is not intended that the scope of any claim element be interpreted based on the application of 35 U.S.C. § 112(f).

Claims

1. A blank for forming a paperboard envelope, the blank comprising: a single rectangular sheet of paperboard, having opposed top and bottom edges, opposed left and right edges, and a first surface and a second opposing surface, the sheet having a midline spaced equally from the left and right edges, the midline comprising a cut that extends from the top edge to a point spaced from the top edge and a fold line that extends from the point to the bottom edge, and the sheet having a first zone on the first surface that extends from the midline to the right edge along the bottom edge, a second zone on the first surface that extends from the bottom edge to a line spaced from the top edge, the line parallel to the top and bottom edges and disposed through the point, along the right edge, a third zone on the first surface that extends from the midline to the left edge along the bottom edge, and a fourth zone on the first surface that extends from the bottom edge to the line along the left edge, the first and second zones being configured to join the third and fourth zones, respectively, on the first surface with the blank folded about the fold line, wherein, in an assembled state, the top edges form a closable opening with the first and second zones joined to and facing the third and fourth zones, respectively, and the blank folded about the fold line, wherein the closable opening has a closed state with the first surface adjacent the top edge between the left edge and the cut and the top edge and the line completely joined and secured to and facing the first surface adjacent the top edge between the right edge and the cut and the top edge and the line, and wherein a width from the fold line to the left or right edge is less than a length from the top edge to the bottom edge.
 2. The blank according to claim 1, further comprising an adhesive disposed in the first and second zones.
 3. The blank according to claim 1, further comprising an adhesive disposed in a fifth zone on the first surface that extends from the midline to the right edge along the top edge, and a release liner disposed over the adhesive in the fifth zone.
 4. The blank according to claim 3, wherein the adhesive is a pressure-sensitive adhesive.
 5. The blank according to claim 1, further comprising a tear strip disposed between the line and the bottom edge, the tear strip having a first end spaced from the midline and a second end spaced from the right edge.
 6. The blank according to claim 1, further comprising at least one line spaced inwardly from the left edge, the bottom edge, and the right edge, the at least one line being scored or grooved.
 7. The blank according to claim 1, wherein no adhesive is applied to the first surface adjacent the midline between the bottom edge and the line.
 8. An envelope formed from a blank according to claim 1.
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